

TOP 20 ENGLISH GRAMMAR RULES (ENGLISH & ODIA)

Complete Exam-Oriented Notes with Concepts & Examples | Study Sathi

Candidate: Brahmasankar Patra

Medium: English & Odia Explanation

Target: OSSSC / SSC / OSSC

Rule 01 Subject-Verb Agreement (Singular & Plural)

A singular subject takes a singular verb, while a plural subject takes a plural verb.

Odia: Subject singular thile verb singular heba (*is, was, has, plays*), subject plural thile verb plural heba (*are, were, have, play*).

✗ Incorrect: The students is reading.

✓ Correct: The students are reading. / The student is reading.

Rule 02 As well as / Together with / Along with

When two subjects are joined by *as well as, along with, together with, in addition to*, the verb agrees with the first subject.

Odia: Jadi duiti subject *as well as / along with* dwara jodijai thae, tebe verb prathama subject anusare lagiba.

✗ Incorrect: The teacher along with his students are present.

✓ Correct: The teacher along with his students is present.

Rule 03 Either...or / Neither...nor

When subjects are connected by *either...or* or *neither...nor*, the verb agrees with the nearest subject.

Odia: *Neither...nor* ba *Either...or* re verb ti tara pakhare thiba subject anusare base.

✗ Incorrect: Neither Rahul nor his friends was present.

✓ Correct: Neither Rahul nor his friends were present.

Rule 04 Each / Every / Either / Neither

Words like *Each, Every, Either, Neither, Everyone, Nobody, Somebody* always take a singular verb.

Odia: Ei words gula sabubela singular hisabare count hue au singular verb nianthi.

✗ Incorrect: Each of the boys were given a prize.

✓ Correct: Each of the boys was given a prize.

Rule 05 One of the + Plural Noun + Singular Verb

After the phrase *One of the*, use a plural noun and a singular verb.

Odia: *One of the* pare noun plural thiba kintu verb sabubela singular heba.

✗ Incorrect: One of my friend are a doctor.

✓ Correct: One of my friends is a doctor.

Rule 06 The number of vs. A number of

The number of takes a singular verb, while **A number of** takes a plural verb.

Odia: *The number of* nirdishta sankhya bujhae (singular verb); *A number of* mane bahut sankhyak bujhae (plural verb).

- ✓ **Correct:** A number of students are absent today.
- ✓ **Correct:** The number of students in the class is 50.

Rule 07 Uncountable Nouns

Words like **Furniture, Advice, Information, Luggage, Baggage, Hair, Scenery, Bread** are uncountable and always singular. Never add **s/es**.

Odia: Emame uncountable noun, tei ehanka sahita s/es lage nahi au verb singular base.

- ✗ **Incorrect:** The sceneries of Kashmir are beautiful.
- ✓ **Correct:** The scenery of Kashmir is beautiful.

Rule 08 Plural in form, Singular in meaning

Nouns like **Mathematics, Physics, News, Politics, Economics, Innings** look plural but take a singular verb.

Odia: Dekhibaku plural lagilebi emame sabda subject ba bisaya bujhanti, tei singular verb lage.

- ✗ **Incorrect:** The news are true.
- ✓ **Correct:** The news is true.

Rule 09 Two-part items (Always Plural)

Items with two symmetrical parts (e.g. **Scissors, Trousers, Spectacles, Pliers**) take a plural verb unless preceded by **a pair of**.

Odia: Duiti saman angsha thiba jinisare plural verb lage, kintu aagaru *A pair of* lagile singular heba.

- ✓ **Correct:** My spectacles are broken.
- ✓ **Correct:** A pair of spectacles is on the table.

Rule 10 Correlative Conjunction Pairs

Correlative conjunctions must be used in fixed pairs: **Hardly/Scarcely... when, No sooner... than, Not only... but also, Although... yet**.

Odia: Ei jodi sabubela fix; *Hardly* sahita *when* au *No sooner* sahita *than* hi lagiba.

- ✗ **Incorrect:** Hardly had I arrived then it started raining.
- ✓ **Correct:** Hardly had I arrived when it started raining.

Rule 11 Inversion Rule with Negative Adverbs

When a sentence starts with *Hardly, Scarcely, Seldom, No sooner*, the auxiliary verb comes before the subject.

Odia: Bakya negative adverb ru aarambha hele helping verb ti subject aagaku aasi jae.

✗ Incorrect: No sooner I reached the station than the train left.

✓ Correct: No sooner did I reach the station than the train left.

Rule 12 Lest... should

Lest means "otherwise / in case". It is always followed by *should*, and never takes a negative word (*not*).

Odia: *Lest* ra artha "nahale emiti heijiba". Ehi word sahita sabubela *should* base au *not* lage nahi.

✗ Incorrect: Walk fast lest you will miss the train.

✓ Correct: Walk fast lest you should miss the train.

Rule 13 Past Perfect for Consecutive Past Actions

When two events happened in the past, the earlier action takes *Past Perfect (had + V3)* and the subsequent action takes *Simple Past (V2)*.

Odia: Atita re duta ghātana ghati thile, prathame ghati thiba ghātana re *had + V3* au pare ghati thiba ghātana re *V2* lagiba.

✓ Correct: The patient had died before the doctor arrived.

Rule 14 Conditional Sentences (Type 3 / Unreal Past)

If the 'if clause' has *had + V3*, the main clause must use *would have + V3*.

Odia: *If clause* re *had + V3* thile, main clause re nischita bhabare *would have + V3* lagiba.

✗ Incorrect: If you worked hard, you would have passed.

✓ Correct: If you had worked hard, you would have passed.

Rule 15 Since vs. For (Time Prepositions)

Since is used for a point of time (e.g., 2010, Monday, 5 PM), while *For* is used for a period/duration of time (e.g., 2 hours, 5 years).

Odia: Nirdishta samaya (point of time) pain *Since* au samaya ra abadhi (duration) pain *For* use hue.

✓ Correct: I have been living here since 2015.

✓ Correct: I have been studying for 3 hours.

Rule 16 Comparative Adjectives ending in '-ior'

Adjectives ending in *-ior* (*Senior, Junior, Superior, Inferior, Prior, Preferable*) take *to*, never *than*.

Odia: *-ior* re sesha heba sabda sahita comparison bele *than* badalare sabubela *to* lage.

✗ Incorrect: He is senior than me.

✓ Correct: He is senior to me.

Rule 17 Superlative Degree + Article 'The'

Always use the definite article **the** before a superlative degree of comparison.

Odia: Superlative degree (best, tallest, highest) aagare sabubela *the* lagiba.

✗ Incorrect: Mount Everest is highest peak in the world.

✓ Correct: Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.

Rule 18 Avoid Double Comparatives and Superlatives

Do not use *more/most* with adjectives that are already in comparative or superlative form.

Odia: Duiti comparative ba superlative word ekathi use karibani.

✗ Incorrect: He is more taller than his brother.

✓ Correct: He is taller than his brother.

Rule 19 Prepositions followed by Gerund (V1 + ing)

When a verb immediately follows a preposition, it must be in the Gerund (-ing) form.

Odia: Preposition pare kounasi verb aasile sahi verb re *-ing* judijae (e.g. *Look forward to*, *Addicted to* pare bi V1+ing lage).

✗ Incorrect: She is good at cook.

✓ Correct: She is good at cooking. / I look forward to meeting you.

Rule 20 Pronoun case after 'Between' and Prepositions

Use the objective case of pronouns (**me, him, her, us, them**) after prepositions and the word *between*.

Odia: Preposition ba *Between* pare pronouns sabubela objective form re rahiba (I badalare me, he badalare him).

✗ Incorrect: There is an agreement between you and I.

✓ Correct: There is an agreement between you and me.